

Corporeity and Affectivity

Dedicated to Maurice Merleau-Ponty

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BRILL

LEIDEN • BOSTON

2014

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THE HYLETIC TIME-CONSCIOUSNESS AND THE EMBODIED SUBJECT¹

Nicola Zippel

1. *The Living Present and Its Hyletic-egological Structure.* *The C-manuscripts*

In the detailed reflections on the time-consciousness' structure from the 1930s² Edmund Husserl inquires the peculiarities of the hyletic sphere, which is crucial in order to understand the relationship between consciousness and the I with regard to the question of constitution.

Husserl describes a sort of descent from the abstract-formal concept of present to the concrete one: the process of concretion of the stream of consciousness happens through the *materializing* of contents within the respective formal moments; therefore, the transition from impression to impression, thus to retention, implies the correspondent transition from content of impression to content of retention, according to the difference of the manners of givenness, which Husserl thoroughly explained in the *Time-Lectures* of 1905.³ What actualizes itself in the consciousness' structures has its correspondence in the material dimension, in which it becomes effective, i.e. concrete.

In the hyletic sphere, Husserl writes, what happens is the «temporalization of the concrete present as impressional present of persisting unities and pluralities [...] [it] is the first and more original temporalization of the time-mode present, and then of the time-mode past».⁴ That a consciousness' structure temporalizes itself, means that it actualizes de facto its own temporal essence, i.e. that it inscribes itself in a material ambit in which it lives concretely in the modes of a present, a past and a future. In this sense, the stream of consciousness is soaked in materiality, since it was otherwise only an abstract form, which could not determine the real

¹ The paper was presented at the conference in German with the title: *Das hyletische Zeitbewusstsein und das verleblichte Subjekt*.

² Edmund Husserl, *Späte Texte über Zeitkonstitution (1929–1934). Die C-Manuskripte*, Hrsg. von D. Lohmar, «Husserliana Materialien VIII» (Dordrecht, 2006).

³ Edmund Husserl, *On the Phenomenology of the Consciousness of Internal Time*, trans. John Barnett Brough, (Dordrecht, 1991).

⁴ Husserl, *Späte Texte*, C 3, p. 84 (my translation).

process of becoming, where it is possible to find the continual presence of an object. In order to directly grasp the hyletic sphere, Husserl follows the method of reduction, which in this case is not directed to the transcendent world to revealing the transcendental subjectivity as its sense-source, but it concerns the flux of the same subjectivity. This entails a new step of the radicalness of the phenomenological method.

Through systematic and progressive exclusions the investigation reaches the sphere of the immanence of consciousness, in which both pure perceptions, that give immediately evident givennesses, and such perceptions, which refer to the transcendent appearances, live together. The latter is lacking in the pureness of the immanence, and the reduction in this case aims to make only the immanent life of the stream of consciousness stand out. Although this stream of consciousness contains the pure sphere of perception, it is described by Husserl as the “primal *impression*al stream of present (*urimpressionaler Gegenwartsstrom*)” and not as “perceiving”.⁵

This choice of words by Husserl, although not a novelty inside these manuscripts, is of considerable importance in *this* context, since it describes the originary core of the living present. Thus such a core has its fundamental trait in the *impressionality*, namely in a special *passive* structure, which as *primal* marks the starting point of the perceiving (active) subject's life.

If one understands the proper sense of this inborn passivity, which belongs to the ultimate time-consciousness' structure, it is possible to gain the comprehension of the essence of relationship between hyle and consciousness. From the following Husserl's quotation one gathers that the role of passivity in this relationship is not accidental:

This primal impressional flowing present of the concrete originally presence has then the following quite universal structure: a) the phenomenological residuum of the proper perceivable side of mundane realities etc., namely the sensation-hyle, the originary hyle in its own temporalization; b) the I with all open and concealed egological components, belonging there: all components of the worldly apprehension, all components of the worldly „reference“, of what is essentially according to a horizon [*Horizontmäßigkeit*], of the worldly representations and so on.⁶

Thus *within* the living present, as an always original moment, as a moment of the presence of consciousness to itself by the modes of the

⁵ Cf. *ibid.*, C 6, p. 110.

⁶ *Ibid.*

impressionality, two different and *at the same time founding* features cohabit: the hyletic sphere and the egological one. Consciousness identifies neither with the former nor with the latter, because both supply to the forming of its whole structure, i.e. the one of the living present.

Such a configuration is then on the one hand originary impressional or rather passive, with regard to the hyletic sensation-data, but on the other hand it is perceiving or rather active, in a subjective relation to the mundane horizon. If one considers more precisely this double dimension, it seems however not to be symmetric, since the impressional moment is *primal-impressional*, and therefore one should not say “on the one hand... on the other hand”, but consciousness as living present is *at first* shaped according to the hyletic sensation-data and *then* it performs something as a world-directed I. There clearly is a *dualistic* interpretation of the structure of the living present (which seems in turn, however, to be a *tertium datur*), wherein two moments are not in contrast but rather seem to be mutual complementary: «The originary hyle is in its own temporalization in a figurative sense the Ego-alien [*ichfremd*] core of the concrete present».⁷ According to this perspective, the hyle seems to be a sort of fixed reference point, which allows the I, that has dived in the concrete stream of the present, to refer to something alien but at the same time always familiar.⁸

The hyletic originary structure of time-consciousness plays a decisive role also in the constitution of nature. Such a constitution derives from a “primordial core”, which doesn’t make up the whole objective world, but represents the starting point of the sense-bestowing process: «The objective nature is not purely and simply constituted on the basis of the unitary hyle, but is constituted only the primordial core, by which for me the sense nature is constituted at the first level».⁹ Hence one must take notice of the difference already within nature between a first level and a second one, since, like Husserl remarks in the passage just quoted, a novel core is deduced from the hyletic core, namely the one of nature, which is here more properly described as “primordial”. As regards to this primal core one can recognize the natural sphere as given to me and as

⁷ Ibid.

⁸ «It is this implicit, non-observational, pre-reflective self-consciousness which allows the experience to be felt as part of my stream of consciousness. The sense of ownership or mineness for the experience thus involves no reflective, second-order, metacognition», Gallagher, S., Zahavi, D., *The Phenomenological Mind. An Introduction to Philosophy of Mind and Cognitive Science* (London and New York, 2008), p. 80.

⁹ Husserl, *Späte Texte*, C 6, p. III.

sense-bearer. But how does nature meet the immanent consciousness' structures?

To the natural temporalization, namely the first one, the primordial one, corresponds in the core of the primordial nature the core of the natural temporalization, i.e. the flowing natural perception (as core of all the mundane perception).¹⁰

The concept of "core" assumes in this context a strategic significance, because it activates *from the inside* the totality of the consciousness' shape. Each level of constitution of the stream has its fixed core. On the one hand it develops itself with an internal coherence around it, on the other it refers to a next level. This process occurs in a complex play of interweavements. Thus the living present has the primal impression as its original core, to which it characterizes itself as constant present streaming. From such a core, the retentional and protentional ramifications of the immanent time also depart, since the primal impression can transcend itself through its own core. In this way, it just assumes the shape of the immanent time, which in turn are gone over by the hyletic field. Such a field refers to the intentional moments of the immanence, so that it develops in itself a corresponding core, the one of the primordial nature. In the end, the core of perception contacts this natural core: «For the temporalization of the nature in the primordially or rather in my immanent sphere we encounter once again and soon a core, namely in primordial nature my body is pre-eminent, and for the primordial core-perception, for the nature-perception, the body-perception».¹¹

Two different, though connected, cores work on the double level of nature and of perception: the body as spatial essence and its perception. If one observes the points of the constitutive process, wherein the figure of core always emerges, one can notice that this figure is related to the *material moment* or at least to the *material side* of the constituting phase. This side is now the originary impression as passive structure of consciousness, now the immanent time in its not-egological aspect, now the shape of the objective nature, now the spatial position of the subject on the basis of its bodily being.

Thus Husserl wonders almost astonishingly in the middle of his reflections: «In the level of the nature: does the constitution of the hyle (temporalization of the sensation-data) precede in itself the constitution of the

¹⁰ Ibid.

¹¹ Ibid.

concrete stream of mental processes as a unitary being-field?». ¹² Following the text and reading between the lines, it is possible to ascertain the pre-eminence of the hyletic moment over the purely conscious one. In a margin note of the original manuscript transcribed by the editor as footnote of the page just quoted, the answer appears as explicit as it is fleeting: «Why precede? Within all the change, within all the eventual stratification of the stream of mental processes, the core-constitution lies necessarily enclosed». ¹³ If such a constitution concerns first of all the material dimension, which belongs as *Ur-Hyle* to the quite universal structure of living present, one can presume that the self-constitution of matter precedes the one of the stream of mental processes. Furthermore, if the shape of the existing individuality as bodily individuality belongs to this stream, ¹⁴ it is necessary that it presupposes the self-formation of material core, namely the temporalization of sensation-data. In this way, the subject can recognize its own property at first as bodily or rather “embodied” property, distinguishing itself from the being undifferentiated of streaming of the living present. This recognition of the subject refers to, then, the first form of individuality, which coincides precisely with the experience of its body. On the basis of the hyletic shape of time-consciousness the singular “temporalization” [*Verzeitigung*] of the I takes place, namely the temporalization of the Ego-life by means of the continuous embodied realization of its acts, which in turn designates the genesis of the man-subject. According to Husserl, one has to take into consideration «that by the temporalization [*Verzeitigung*] of the Ego’s acts and of the Ego itself the humanization [*Vermenschlichung*] comes about, especially the self-humanization of the primary shape, the embodiment [*Verleiblichung*] of my Ego». ¹⁵ The process of the constitution, which starts with the self-temporalization of the living present, ends with the formation of its own body: for the Ego, the discovery of its body means the exploration of its hyletic root in time-consciousness. Body and Ego represent two sides of the unique temporal structure, which has its fundamental *medium* in the hyle. Hence, there is no contrast between subject as body and the same subject as Ego, since both the body and the Ego make up two strata of the consciousness’ constitution.

¹² Ibid.

¹³ Ibid.

¹⁴ Cf. *ibid.*, p. 110.

¹⁵ *Ibid.*, C 16, p. 345.

Only by a phenomenological abstraction are we able to think of an Ego without body: there is certainly no body without Ego, though an Ego exists only as embodied. The material mark of the constitution is the clue that the phenomenologist must follow to understand his worldly existence as human subject.

2. *Matter Without Ego and Pure I: The Abstractive Regard on Time-Consciousness. Passage to the Bernau Texts*

In a passage from a manuscripts from 1931, Husserl points out that the I, «in its more originary originality, is not in the time», and he specifies that in this context “time” means «the constantly self-temporalizing and temporalizing present as originary modal living present».¹⁶ Stating the not-temporality of the I stands for saying that the originary Ego-core, its primitive trait, doesn’t belong to that sphere of living present, which experiences a continuous self-temporalization. While that doesn’t completely exclude the I from the dimension of living present, it restricts to this dimension a totally not-egological part, the one of the matter. *Both* spheres contribute to the *original* constitution of the sense of existing:

The constitution of the existents on different levels, of worlds, of times, has two original presuppositions, two original sources, which temporal speaking (in all of these temporalities) are always “at the basis” of it: 1) My originary I as functioning [...]. 2) My originary not-I as originary stream of temporalization and itself as originary shape of temporalization, which constitutes a temporal field, the one of the originary materiality. But both original presuppositions are unique, indivisible, and so abstract considered in itself.¹⁷

Only a methodological abstraction allows grasping separately two fundamental moments of constitution, each of them taken in its individual shape. They are, however, *concretely* unique, because one refers always to the other, within a peculiar process, which originates and takes place in the intentional-temporal field of living present. The uncancellable character of the *intentional temporality* combines the hyletic sphere with the subjective one: the matter is the *humus* of a consciousness-of, it is the sustenance of the consciousness’ features, the concrete surround of their intentional temporalization, while the I is the functioning centre, which

¹⁶ Ibid., C 10, p. 197.

¹⁷ Ibid., C 10, p. 199.

always co-ordinates through affections and actions the different consciousness' moments and their material content. This primordial hyletic-subjective mechanism presides over all the acts of our intentional life as its basis.

If the matter is totally *ichlos*, lacking of any subjective, i.e. personal mark, the I is on the contrary always absorbed in an alien surround, namely it is «always-with (*immer dabei*)»¹⁸ the original hyletic flux, and this "being-with" has the peculiar forms of a «feeling being-with (*ein fühlendes Dabei-Sein*)»¹⁹, a being-with structurally open to the affections, and thus to actions. Husserl calls the «original legality [*Urgesetzlichkeit*]» the one which rules the relation between hyle and I, a legality «according to which an egological stratum of the temporalized affections and actions, a materialized stratum, temporally materialized, unites with the originary hyletic stratum».²⁰ As submitted to originary legality, the wedding between subject and matter is *ab initio* combined, and both contracting cannot choose differently. Through a quite peculiar relationship, which assumes the form of the union to the matter, the Ego joins the temporal dimension of the stream of consciousness that surrounds it. It is a peculiar relationship, because the Ego is *supra*-temporal [*überzeitlich*], though it is always time-referred [*Zeitbezogen*]. In which sense is the I not-temporal and *at the same time* temporal? That is not a simple play on words but a serious phenomenological question.

The detailed analysis of the act-structure allows to further elucidate the characteristics of the fundamental features of living present. Hence, if one pays close attention to a single act, one finds:

- 1) First of all, the inferior temporal stratum of the "objective", to which the act is directed. 2) Secondly, as superior stratum [we find] the immanent temporal act itself, in its act-realizations [...] which are temporalized [*verzeitlicht*] together with the inferior stratum. 3) But we also find properly temporalized [*verzeitigt*] the I of the realization, who remains the same during the act [...], the [I as] identical performer through all modes of realization, which are always valid for him.²¹

The process of temporalization [*Verzeitigung*] of the Ego is thus filtered by the act-realization, since the act is directed to the inferior stratum of the material objectivity, and so it becomes temporal; but while the act, as it

¹⁸ Cf. *ibid.*, C 10, p. 200.

¹⁹ Cf. *ibid.*, C 16, p. 351.

²⁰ *Ibid.*, C 10, p. 200.

²¹ *Ibid.*, C 10, p. 201.

gets in touch with the hyletic sphere, shares with such a sphere all passages implicated in the temporal streaming, the I, as act-performer, doesn't share the flowing destiny, and lasts in its current identity. Although the act-realization and the I of mine who has performed the act have elapsed, I myself have not elapsed, since I am again, even if submitted to the unavoidable event of the self-temporalization, the I who remains the same during the act is not something lasting through the act as filled temporal duration in the same sense like something temporal lasts, but [one sees] that it is itself something identical during the material duration, without extension, a now which lasts in the change of its realizations.²²

Like the act that it realizes, the Ego has duration, which is not *in the same sense* of either the act or the act-objectivity. The act is temporalized together with the objective stratum, and it gets a material duration, materialized, which goes over the stream of consciousness according to the different degrees of the past; that the I lasts means it *remains the same* (*steht und bleibt*), in a constant, fixed, not-stretched "now", wherein it recognizes itself as performer of its own acts. Both the act and the Ego have an identity, but the one of the act coincides with determined temporal locus, while «the identity of the I is not the simple identity of something lasting, but it is the identity of the performer [*des Vollziehers*, which Husserl in a footnote names also *Ich-Pol*]».²³

It is clear that Husserl identifies the *supra*-temporality of the I with that part of the subject, which he also calls Ego-Pole; although the latter is factually not separable from the personal-worldly dimension of the I, one must make this separation methodologically, i.e. abstractly, in order to grasp the essential core of the subjectivity. Conversely, or rather *correlatively*, it will allow seeing even more plainly the basic nature of the materiality. A very interesting text dating back to the Bernau inquiries, namely more than ten years before the C-manuscripts, lets one formulate such a methodological abstraction. In this text Husserl divided two constitutive components of the living present starting from the material dimension that is obtained by «the abstraction *from an I and from all egological* – a simple abstraction, though important», in consequence of which «we have in the first immanent temporal order the sensation-data and the sensible feelings».²⁴ Following Husserl's reflections one can note that this

²² Ibid., C 10, pp. 201–202.

²³ Ibid., C 10, p. 202.

²⁴ Edmund Husserl, *Die Bernauer Manuskripte über das Zeitbewusstsein (1917/18)*, Husserliana XXXIII, Hrsg. von R. Bernet und D. Lohmar (Dordrecht, 2001), pp. 275–276

first region of time-consciousness may be internally divided on the one hand in the sphere of stimuli and reactions, and on the other hand, in the sensible tendencies like association and reproduction, which are «totally un-egological [*völlig ichlos*]», and for this reason they don't involve the I. According to Husserl, they represent, like in the C-manuscripts, the so called «passive intentionality. Here is the I, also as the Pole of affections and reactions, thought as not in stake, or rather abstracted from that. We have then a first structure, which has been “abstractly” singled out, the one of the passivity of the originary sensuality».²⁵

The trait of passivity inside consciousness is marked by the absence of all the characters referable not only to the activity of the I, but also to its reactivity, to its suffering what is alien from it; for this reason, at a methodological level of inquiry, it is excluded from the region of the originary sensibility “the I, also as Pole of affections and reactions”, in order to isolate in its pureness the *totally un-egological* area, wherein the processes of association and reproduction develop through the continuous interrelations of the basic consciousness' moments like impression, retention and protention. Although they are concretely inseparable from a subjective being, their existence is not due to this subject, but rather they constitute the background, which is necessary to build up a personal-subjective life.²⁶ If we proceed in the methodological reflections, and consider the Ego-Pole, we grasp «the realm of affections and reactions, which certainly presupposes the first level»,²⁷ i.e. the one of the originary associations and reproductions. In this second stage we don't reach however the rational I, which by its aptitude consciously refers to its hyletic surround; such an I is reached only in a new step that leads to the «third level (which presupposes the previous ones), the realm of the *intellectus agens*».²⁸ How do these three stages, only abstractly separable, cohabit within a

(my translation). Rudolf Bernet remarks that the fact that the passive dimension receives in the Bernau inquiries a first, comprehensive analysis, shows that the *genetic* phase of the Husserlian thought begins before the lectures on passive synthesis of 1920s. Cf. *ibid.*, *Einleitung der Herausgeber*, pp. XXXVII and XLVI.

²⁵ *Ibid.*, p. 276.

²⁶ It has been deduced from the purposed analysis of the C-manuscripts mentioned above, which receive a similar interpretation by Dan Zahavi, who states that «the fact that we are confronted with an unthematic, implicit, immediate, and passive occurrence, which is by no means initiated, regulated, or controlled by the ego, suggest that we are dealing with a given state of pure passivity, with a form of *self-affection*». See Zahavi, *Inner Time-Consciousness and Pre-reflective Self-awareness*, in Donn Welton, Ed., *The New Husserl. A Critical Reader* (Bloomington, 2003), pp. 172–173.

²⁷ Husserl, *Die Bernauer Manuskripte*, p. 276.

²⁸ *Ibid.*

same structure, the one of the immanent temporality, which in turn makes up the basic trait of the living present? What regulates what Husserl calls “temporal order” is one of the most fundamental traits of time-constitution, the shape of the *Deckung*, the *coincidence* that takes continuously place among the different phases of time-consciousness: «in this way – Husserl explains – we have tried to build us the universal realm of the immanent time or of the self-“coinciding” immanent temporal orders».²⁹ Thus, the *time as coincidence* allows the reciprocal contacts between these remarkably heterogeneous dimensions of consciousness: they are heterogeneous, even though they share the same *temporal* essence. And yet there is a level, which is not authentically “temporal”, namely the one of the Ego-Pole, which distinguishes itself as not-temporal, because not all the subjective is something temporal, something individual in the sense of something individualized by a unique temporal locus. What above all we don’t have in the stream of mental processes is the Ego itself, the identical centre, the pole, to which the total content of the stream of mental processes refers [...].³⁰

We don’t find the Ego within the stream of mental processes, because it is not a mental process, but the point – the pole – of reference of all the mental processes and their content. The Ego could not absolve this role if it were deep in the stream like any other mental process. In this “spatial” sense, the I as Pole is *out* or rather *supra*-temporal:

it is the pole for all the temporal series and as such is necessarily “*supra*”-temporal, the I, for which the time is constituted, for which temporality is there [...], the I that is however not in itself temporal. In this sense is not thus “an existent”, but the counterpart of all the existent, it is not an *object* [*Gegenstand*], but the *primal subject* [*Urstand*] for all objectivity.³¹

In the conceptual scheme outlined by Husserl, “temporal” designates the “existent” (*Seiendes*), which constitutes itself as an I-referred objectivity by means of the sense-bestowing intentional features of consciousness. For this reason, the I cannot be defined as “temporal”, but rather the *pole* of what is temporal, its originary, “primal” sense-condition. The Ego is so what is out, i.e. over the temporal stream, and *as such* it is able not only to refer to this stream, but also to build up the necessary complement of its objectivities. It is the required *Gegen-Pol* of every *Gegen-Stand*. But this is a nonsymmetrical relation, since the I is in turn not facing the object as

²⁹ Ibid., p. 277.

³⁰ Ibid.

³¹ Ibid.

Gegen-Stand, but as *Ur-Stand*, as what is able to consciously name what is opposite, to individualize it in its streaming, to put it in the temporal flux. To name means here to objectivise, and for this reason the Ego is in this sense non nameable, but, on the contrary, «it is the nameless over all is graspable, <it is what>, above all things, is not standing, not pending, not existing, but it is “functioning” as grasping, valuing, and so on».³²

It is about the fundamental notion of the Ego as *Funktionszentrum*, as function-centre performing both in the action and in the reaction, heart of the boundless temporal life of consciousness, which neither identifies itself with nor dissolves in consciousness' moments, but *coincides* with all of them, just like every radius of circumference can be led back to its centre.

3. *On the Concrete Existence:* *The Bodily Constitution of Subject in Ideas II*

The functioning Ego recalls that *pure Ego* described by Husserl in his inquiries of *Ideas II*.³³ And just the meticulous analyses of *Ideas II* allow to understand even better how this Ego descends from its pureness to its material, i.e. *bodily*, existence. These analyses precede chronologically both the inquiries of the C-manuscripts and the ones of Bernau, and for this reason one can consider *Ideas II* as the *basis* of the following Husserlian reflection on this central issue.

In a certain sense, one must read the above quoted pages from the Bernau manuscripts regarding the Ego as “centre” of mental processes together with those passages from *Ideas II*, wherein Husserl talks about the *body* as “centre of orientation”, so that it is in a figurative sense the concrete representative of myself, since every kind of object, real or imagined, «is “to the right” of me; it is “approaching” me or “moving away;” it is “revolving,” turning toward or away from “me” – *from me*, i.e. *from my Body*, from my eye, which is directed at it».³⁴ To be the centre of my experience's references means for the body to be the “medium” between me as subject and other things. This medial position is, first of all, a spatial one, since the body is «the place where, and always by essential necessity, a system of

³² Ibid., p. 278. On these pages from the Bernau manuscripts see the sharp remarks by Eduard Marbach in *Mental Representation and Consciousness. Towards a Phenomenological Theory of Representation and Reference* (Dordrecht, 1993), pp. 89–92.

³³ Edmund Husserl, *Ideas pertaining to a pure phenomenology and to a phenomenological philosophy*, Second Book, *Studies in the phenomenology of constitution*, trans. Richard Rojcewicz and André Schuwer (Dordrecht, 1989), pp. 103–127.

³⁴ Ibid., p. 62 (my emphasis).

subjective conditionality is interwoven with this system of causality [...]».³⁵ So, if from an abstractive point of view, the Ego can be grasped in its pureness only apart from its bodily existence, one can understand the subjective real or rather concrete being in a world only considering the dependence from the body. But to comprehend the *total* worldly experience, one has to consider both the bodily *and* the egological side of this experience, and precisely *in their essential connection*: «Hence a distinction is made here between the identical *thing itself* and its subjective conditioned *modes of appearance*; i.e. its subjectively conditioned features which persist in relation *to me, my Body, and my soul*».³⁶

And just this congenital link to the bodily dimension distinguishes the Ego as Psyche from the Ego as Pole, and only the former stands for the *complete* shape of subject, of what Husserl calls in *Ideas II* «the psychic Ego, or the soul», which «has a material thing as his Body, *because* it is animated, i.e., because he has psychic lived experiences which [...] are one with the Body in a singularly intimate way».³⁷ The crucial difference between the Ego as pole and the Ego as soul depends not on their inner formal structure, since the pure Ego too “behaves” and “has states”, but on the fact that «this concept of modes of behavior and of states is totally different than the one which applies to the sphere of reality, where all modes of behavior or states are, in conformity with the constituting apprehension, causally related to “circumstances” [*Umstände*]».³⁸ The pure Ego as such is not related to any circumstances, since it lacks that bond with the bodily dimension, which localizes the Ego as *human*, i.e. as *person*, in a world.³⁹ The pureness of the Ego, as Husserl will go on to explain in the Bernau manuscripts discussed above, is marked precisely by this lacking of ties with any kind of materiality, of a mere thing or of an animated one, like the body. We can grasp this pure state only by abstraction, because the Ego pole is *factually* linked to the psychic and so *indirectly*

³⁵ Ibid., p. 69. The bodily localized perception plays a central role foremost as sense of touch, like Filip Mattens has recently observed. See Mattens, “Perception, Body, and the Sense of Touch: Phenomenology and Philosophy of Mind”, *Husserl Studies* 25 (2009), 97–120.

³⁶ Husserl, *Ideas II*, p. 80 (last emphasis of mine).

³⁷ Ibid., pp. 128 and 129.

³⁸ Ibid., p. 132.

³⁹ In this sense one can point out that «the body has do to with the reality of the human being, not the purity of the being of consciousness. The body exemplifies precisely the sense in which the human ego is *not* pure subjectivity», see James Dodd, *Idealism and Corporeity. An essay on the Problem of the Body in Husserl's Phenomenology* (Dordrecht, 1997), p. 66.

with the bodily aspect of the existence. *Between* the pureness of the Ego and the materiality of the Body lies the Ego as soul, which as Ego animates a body, but it is, as such, at the same time *embodied*. This link to a body appears through the circumstances that determine the factual existence of subject; it refers to these circumstances “causally”, like Husserl explained. But here the mention of a “causal” relation regarding the subject needs a clarification, since Husserl states later that the “causality” «is a constitutive idea for material nature, for the idea of the physical thing».⁴⁰ In fact, the material thing is constituted according to some schemata based on a causal necessity, which doesn’t play any role in the psychic constitution. To be related to circumstances means for the subject as soul «to be related to concomitant complexes of kinetic sensations [*Bewegungsempfindungen*]».⁴¹ But this tie to the bodily movements, which have their lowest or rather fundamental level in the sensibility, i.e. in the immanent time as sensation-data setting, doesn’t indicate a causal bond, as if the subject were submitted to a necessary and impersonal motion schemata. On the contrary, it is the body to be *moveable* by the *free will* of an Ego, which «has the “faculty” (the “I can”) to freely move this Body – i.e., the organ in which it is articulated – and to perceive an external world by means of it».⁴²

The Ego can otherwise also move the mere things like its body; why, then, is this motion relation only as to the body not causal? Because the main difference between the thing and the body, considering that both are expression of materiality, lies first and foremost in their dissimilar relationship with the Ego, and so in their unlike inner constitution. While the matter as thing is something extended, external to a soul, and partakes as such only in the sheer nature, the matter as body is something extended too, but also animated by a soul, and so it receives from this animation a *temporal* feature, of which a mere thing is lacking. This temporal trait emerges as an *historical* mark: «*material things* are conditioned exclusively from the outside and are not conditioned by their own past; they are *history-less realities*».⁴³ On the contrary, the body shares the past of the Ego, which animates it, and for this reason Husserl talks about «mixed

⁴⁰ Husserl, *Ideas II*, p. 134.

⁴¹ *Ibid.*, p. 136.

⁴² *Ibid.*, pp. 159–160. Husserl adds later, that «the Body appears here at the same time as a “turning point” where the causal relations are transformed into conditional relations between the external world and the Bodily-psychic subject», p. 169. As to the psychophysic reality it is about “motivations” than “causality”.

⁴³ *Ibid.*, p. 144.

realities, ones which, like the soul, have a natural side and an idiopsychic side». ⁴⁴ What is applied for the soul, is applied for the body too, since they are two aspects of the same reality, and this reality *as a whole* is what is different from the mere nature as merely material thing: «what we have to oppose to material nature as a second kind of reality is not the “soul” but the *concrete unity* of Body and soul, the human (or animal) subject». ⁴⁵ And the body, as partaking both in the sheer materiality (as thing) and in the psychic life (just as body, as corporeality [*Leiblichkeit*]) is the medium between the Ego and the world. ⁴⁶ But the *basic* medium or rather the *condition of possibility* of this threefold relation Ego - body - world is the *matter*, which constitutes the *fundamental* structure both of the mere things, *and* of the body, *and* of the immanent subjective time, as we learn from reading the Bernau and the C-manuscripts. But already in *Ideas II*, which one can consider the root of the successive Husserlian reflections, the matter plays a decisive *constituting-founding* role, since it receives a spiritual forming, just, as discussed above, the primary sensations undergo *apprehensions*, and are taken up in perceptions, upon which, then, perceptual judgement are built, etc. Hence, in this way, the *human being's total consciousness is in a certain sense, by means of its hyletic substrate, bound to the Body [...]*. ⁴⁷

If the body represents the medium between subject and world, i.e. between subject and its experience of a world, this medium is in turn in need of another *more fundamental medial nexus*, i.e. the one of the *hyle*, which is the basis upon which a subjective life, a *psycho-physical* one, can be constituted.

⁴⁴ Ibid., p. 145.

⁴⁵ Ibid., p. 146.

⁴⁶ As to its medial role the Body can be properly defined a «complex domain of meaning», see Richard Cobb-Stevens, *Body, Spirit and Ego in Husserl's Ideas II*, in Anna-Teresa Tymieniecka, Ed., *Soul and Body in Husserlian Phenomenology. Man and Nature* (Dordrecht 1983), p. 247.

⁴⁷ Husserl, *Ideas II*, p. 160.